Barsha Maharjan

Senior Product Designer

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EXPERTISE

Strategic

Product vision & roadmap, Impact metrics, Opportunity map, Business outcome, Cross-team collaboration, Team leadership and design mentorship

Design

Complex interface design, Design system, User journey map, Prototype/wireframe, Responsive design, Version control, Documentation

Tech and tools

Claude code, Cursor, HTML/CSS, Figma, Lucid chart, Lottie animation, Illustrator, Jira, Hotjar, Maze

Research

Data driven decision, User testing (moderated/unmoderated), Usability test

ARTICLES

UX Reflex Theory: Lessons from Apple's Searchbar Experiment
UX Collective

EDUCATION

Parsons School of Design

MFA in Design and Technology
New York, USA, 2019
Deans Merit and University Scholarship

Saint Xavier's College

BS in Information Management
Kathmandu, Nepal, 2014

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Designer CANDID.ORG 2020 - Present

- Led design of Candid's MCP integration with Anthropic/Claude, expanding AI-powered nonprofit data access to all Claude users.
- Piloted a Generative AI feature converting IRS Form 990 data into readable nonprofit narratives, driving ~90% profile manager adoption.
- Boosted user retention by 50% for org profile claiming and increased Seals of Transparency (data submissions) by 60% through research-led UX redesign.
- Applied design thinking across moderated and unmoderated user research, improving task completion rates across core product flows.
- Designed Candid Data System, an enterprise database platform, improving performance metrics and efficiency through user research-based interface updates.
- Led GuideStar and Foundation Directory redesign on the Candid Search, enabling nonprofit and grantmaker discovery nationwide.
- Spearheaded Philanthropy News Digest redesign as design and development lead, supporting 450K monthly page views.
- Built a scalable design system with variables from scratch, reducing prototyping time by 50% across 7 product teams
- Partnered with engineering, data science & influence to align quarterly delivery with long-term vision.

UX Designer and Developer COREWEAVE 2019

- Designed and developed the revamp of Concierge Renders website, a 3D rendering platform.
- Designed social media assets communicating creator-focused brand identity across digital channels.

UX Research Fellow VERIZON 5G, NYC MEDIA LAB, YAHOO SPORTS 2018

- Received $5K grant to research 5G's impact on sports experiences; conducted 80+ interviews via Lean Launchpad over 8 weeks.
- Built a start-up and successfully pitched the demo to investors.

Teaching and Research Assistant PARSONS SCHOOL OF DESIGN 2018 - 2019

- Taught a bootcamp course to incoming graduate students in the Design and Technology program covering front-end development, digital product design, and design thinking and principles.
- Collaborated with Tongji University in China for an interactive course, Motion Capture at a Distance.

UX Designer and Developer FUSEMACHINES 2014 - 2017

- Led end-to-end web projects across tech and education clients, managing design templates, prototypes, and client relationships.

MENTORSHIPS

AIGA NY Mentor 2025
Technology for Equity and Justice Fellowship Advisory group 2022 - Present
MIT Reality Hack Mentor 2024
All Women Virtual Hackathon Mentor 2022

FIGMA PLUGINS

Accessibility Simulator Features: Vision simulator, Motor control analysis and Cognitive load analysis
AI Text and Lorem Ipsum Generator Features: Custom character count, Revert to original text
WCAG Color Contrast Checker Features: Color contrast analysis, Accessible color suggestion